

- **Spring Framework** is a comprehensive infrastructure for building Java applications, offering core features like Dependency Injection (DI), Inversion of Control (IoC), and modules (e.g., Spring MVC, Security, Data). It requires manual configuration (XML or Java) and setup of dependencies, servers, and deployment descriptors.
- **Spring Boot** is an opinionated extension of the Spring Framework that simplifies development through auto-configuration, embedded servers (Tomcat, Jetty), and production-ready features (metrics, health checks). It minimizes boilerplate code and configuration, allowing you to "just run" a Spring application.

Example:

With **Spring**, creating a web app means configuring `web.xml`, setting up a `DispatcherServlet`, and defining beans explicitly.

With **Spring Boot**, you add `spring-boot-starter-web` dependency, write a `@SpringBootApplication` class, and run `main()` — the embedded Tomcat starts automatically, and common beans are auto-configured.

In short: **Spring = flexible foundation, Spring Boot = convention-over-configuration starter kit** built on top of Spring.